



The Selectboard
TOWN OF WESTHAMPTON
TOWN HALL
1 SOUTH ROAD
WESTHAMPTON, MASSACHUSETTS 01027

Minutes of the Meeting
Wednesday, February 25, 2026, 7:30 PM
at the Town Hall, 1 South Road

CALL TO ORDER

The Selectboard was called to order at 5:02 PM

PRESENT: Susan Bronstein (Chair), Scott Johndrow, Jennifer Milikowsky

ALSO PRESENT: Douglas Finn, Others as noted.

PUBLIC COMMENT on any item not on the agenda

No public comment given.

SECOND INTERVIEW – Municipal Accountant

Board will conduct an interview with candidate(s) for municipal accountant. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn noted that the applicant to be interviewed was unavailable to attend, and requested that the interview be placed on the next available agenda.

Ms. Patty Cotton reported from the screening committee, and noted that the applicant was excellent and highly recommended.

No objection.

UPDATE – Hampshire County Group Insurance Trust

Board may receive an update from Ryan Mailloux, Town Treasurer, about status of HCGIT

Mr. Finn noted that Mr. Mailloux was unavailable due to prior commitments. However, he reported that the HCGIT voted to adopt a 12.48% increase to premiums for FY2027, a significant reduction from the anticipated 20% increase. However, the premium will be accompanied by specific plan changes:

	BCBSMA HMO BLUE NEW ENGLAND		BCBSMA BLUE CARE ELECT PREFERRED PPO	
Network Benefits	Current	Proposed	Current	Proposed
Plan Year Plan Deductible (Individual / Family)	\$0 Network Benefits Only	\$250 / \$500 Network Benefits Only	Network \$0 Non-Network \$250 / \$500	\$250 / \$500 Network and Non-Network Combined
Office Copay PCP	\$20	\$20	\$20	\$20 after Deductible
Office Copay Specialist	\$35	\$60	\$35	\$60 after Deductible
Urgent Care	\$35	\$60	\$35	\$60 after Deductible
Emergency Room	\$100 Copay	\$100 Copay	\$100 Copay	\$100 after deductible
Lab	Covered at 100%	\$0 after Deductible	Covered at 100%	\$0 after Deductible
Inpatient Care	\$250 Copay	\$500 after Deductible	\$250 Copay	\$500 after Deductible
Outpatient Surgical	\$150 Copay	\$250 After Deductible	\$150 Copay	\$250 After Deductible
Plan Year Out of Pocket Maximum (Individual / Family)	\$5,000 / \$10,000	\$5,000 / \$10,000	\$5,000 / \$10,000	\$5,000 / \$10,000

Due to the plan changes, the Selectboard was recommended to formally take action **to begin the process**

to change health insurance benefits under G.L. c. 32B, §§21-23. Mr. Finn further advised the board that the vote should not take place until the next regular meeting, and advised adding it to the agenda for March 9. Agreed by consensus.

AUTO DEALERS' LICENSE RENEWAL – Jon Albitz, Berkshire Classics, Kings Highway

Board will review application for renewal of Class II license. Votes may be taken.

The board reviewed the application as presented. After review, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To renew the license for CY2026.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (5:26 PM)

CDBG BLOCK GRANT APPLICATION – Town of Chesterfield

Board will consider participating in a joint application for CDBG grant funding. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn presented a 'Joint Application Authorization' from the Town of Chesterfield and the Hilltowns CDC for review. Ms. Bronstein spoke in favor of the program, as did Ms. Mary Lou Burgess. After review, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the application, and authorize Ms. Bronstein to sign the letter on behalf of the board.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (5:31 PM)

VETERANS' SERVICES MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING – City of Easthampton

Board will review a proposed "MOU" for management of Chapter 115 Veterans Benefits. Votes may be taken.

The board reviewed the draft MOU. After review, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the MOU, and authorize Ms. Bronstein to sign.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (5:34 PM)

ADMINISTRATIVE

SECURITY IMPROVEMENTS AT TOWN HALL ANNEX

Board will consider a proposal to improve security at the Town Hall Annex. Votes may be taken

The board considered a proposal to construct a security kiosk at the annex. After discussion, the board tabled any action until Building Commissioner Wally Marek could review the space and present a design. Design to be returned to the board prior to implementation.

TOWN HALL ACCESS CONCERNS

Board will consider remediation of physical access at the Town Hall. Votes may be taken.

WEBSITE CALENDAR PROCEDURES

Board will consider procedures for scheduling public and private events at Town Hall. Votes may be taken.

Mr. Finn presented procedures for using the municipal website as the 'authoritative' calendar for all town event functions.

CONTRACT FOR SOLAR PV INSTALLATION AT WESTHAMPTON ELEMENTARY SCHOOL

Board will review final contract prior to execution. Votes may be taken.

Ms. Milikowsky presented the contract for review and adoption. Ms. Milikowsky noted recent changes to the contract which incorporate the Town's decision to cover all permitting fees.

Ms. Milikowsky also noted that a meeting on Friday would lead to a final placement of the battery energy storage system; a significant change to the proposed location could result in a contract change order, but the expectation that the BESS would be placed closed to the proposed location, without any increase to the contract.

There was discussion about the need for local project reviews by the Fire Department, Conservation Commission and Planning Board; concerns were expressed about the options available to the town if the project might not appear to be viable.

Mr. Johndrow explained some of his concerns about past contracting issues that the Town has had to manage.

It was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the contract, and authorize Ms. Bronstein to sign the contract via DocuSign when available.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (6:03 PM)

BOARD MEMBER CONCERNS

Board may raise topics of new business or propose future action-items. Consensus advice and direction on any topic may be given.

No concerns raised.

CORRESPONDENCE

Board will review correspondence. Consensus advice and direction on any topic may be given.

Correspondence was reviewed. No action taken on any given item.

There was extensive discussion on advisories provided by KP Law in regard to the scope and ability of boards and committees to speak to ballot questions, including a potential proposition 2-1/2 override.

WARRANTS

Board will review and approve A/P and Payroll Warrants #W26-17 and #WP26-17.

The board reviewed the A/P and Payroll warrants. After review, it was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve Warrants W26-17 and WP26-17 as presented.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (6:34 PM)

Ms. Milikowsky asked for clarity in regard to excise tax abatements as they appear on the warrant. There was a brief discussion on the matter. No action taken.

MINUTES

Board will review and approve Meeting Minutes if available.

Minutes of January 28 and February 9 were reviewed. After review, it was MOVED by Milikowsky, SECONDED by Johndrow

To approve the minutes of January 28, 2026.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (6:38 PM)

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky

To approve the minutes of February 9, 2026.

VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (6:38 PM)

Adjourn

It was MOVED by Johndrow, SECONDED by Milikowsky
To Adjourn.

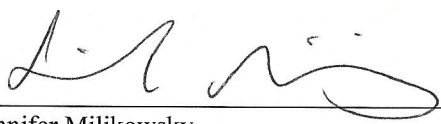
VOTED: 3, 0, 0. (6:39 PM)

Approved by a vote of the Selectboard at a regular meeting, held on March 9, 2026.



Susan Bronstein

Scott Johndrow



Jennifer Milikowsky